

9.6 The report of the visit or issue

Students are required to write a report that should demonstrate knowledge of AS Biology. Students could, for example, write an article for a school magazine or a local paper. The report should be written assuming that readers have knowledge of biology to at least GCSE A*–C standard.

The report will:

- have a clear structure
- be written using technical vocabulary correctly, where appropriate
- incorporate visual methods of presentation
- acknowledge any artwork or photographs from other publications or websites
- demonstrate due care with the clear and correct use of English
- be word processed
- be between 1500 and 2000 words, including text attached to any diagrams, figures, graphs and data tables but not the bibliography.

Illustrations might include computer-generated artwork, scanned examples of students' hand-drawn artwork or students' own photographs.

Students should be allowed a period of at least two to three weeks following the identification of the issue or of making the visit to write and submit their reports. The report will be marked out of a total of 40 marks against the assessment criteria. A mark of 0 will be given if the work submitted is unworthy of any credit. When a student fails to submit work by the due date specified by the centre, this should be indicated by recording A (for absence) in the mark record.

Students should clearly identify the aspects of biology that they observed in the context of the visit or while researching their chosen issue. For each aspect, students should describe the purpose for, or significance of, the biology which is being used. They should demonstrate an ability to recognise biological facts, terminology, principles, relationships, concepts and practical techniques. They should demonstrate an understanding of the ethical, social, economic or environmental implications of the biology encountered within the context of the visit or issue.

Students are required to include a cumulative word count at the bottom of each page.